MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSEFSQA00 - IN FLIGHT FOODSERVICE SYSTEM
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)
Duration: 2 HoursMaximum Marks: 70

QPCODE-25901266

Part A
MCQ
Answer all questions
Each question carries 1 marks

1. Recognize the role of fair treatment in inflight food service delivery.
   Answer: c) Providing equitable service to all passenger classes
2. Identify the correct meaning of inflight food service.
   Answer: a) Provision of meals and beverages to passengers during air travel
3. Identify the significance of food service on long-haul flights.
   Answer: b) Enhancing passenger comfort and satisfaction
4. Recall the contribution of inflight food service to passenger comfort.
   Answer: c) Provision of timely and appropriate meals
5. Identify the primary purpose of regulatory frameworks in inflight food service.
   Answer: c) Ensuring food safety and passenger health
6. Recognize the type of catering truck designed with a high-lift mechanism.
   Answer: c) High-lift catering truck
7. Identify the preparation method commonly used for hot inflight meals.
   Answer: a) Baking and reheating in aircraft ovens
8. Identify the role of protective clothing in inflight food service.
   Answer: d) Preventing contamination of food
9. Recall the onboard kitchen equipment used for organized transport and distribution of meals.
   Answer: a) Meal cart
10. Identify the primary purpose of temperature control in inflight food storage.
    Answer: b) Preventing microbial growth
11. Recall the practice that enhances passenger comfort during inflight food service.
    Answer: c) Courteous service with clear announcements
12. Select the menu element that supports passengers with dietary awareness.
    Answer: c) Nutritional and allergen information
13. Select the communication behavior that supports positive complaint resolution.
    Answer: c) Using polite language and positive body posture

14. Select the factor that influenced the evolution of inflight catering services.
    Answer: c) Advancement in aircraft technology
15. Select the practice that reflects ethical responsibility in airline catering.
    Answer: b) Fair treatment of catering staff and suppliers
16. Recall the impact of poor hygiene in inflight food service.
    Answer: d) Risk of contamination and illness
17. Recognize the role of HACCP in inflight food service systems.
    Answer: b) Identifying and controlling food safety hazards
18. Select the inventory management practice that supports effective food cost control in airline catering.
    Answer: c) Implementing FIFO method
19. Identify the main objective of developing inflight menus to suit customer needs.
    Answer: b) Meeting diverse passenger expectations
20. Assess the role of passenger feedback in monitoring food service performance.
    Answer: c) Support evaluation of service gaps and improvements

Part B
Short Answer
Answer any 6 questions
Each question carries 5 marks

21. Recognize the link between passenger satisfaction and repeat travel.
Passenger satisfaction plays a crucial role in influencing repeat travel decisions in the airline industry. When passengers receive high-quality inflight food service, courteous behavior from cabin crew, and timely service, they develop a positive perception of the airline. This satisfaction builds trust and loyalty, encouraging passengers to choose the same airline for future journeys. Consistency in service quality further strengthens this relationship. On the other hand, poor service can lead to dissatisfaction and loss of customers. Therefore, maintaining high standards in inflight food service directly contributes to customer retention and repeat business.

22. Identify the food service standard followed by full-service airlines.
Full-service airlines follow a high standard of food service that includes complimentary meals, beverages, and a variety of menu options tailored to passenger preferences. These airlines emphasize quality, hygiene, and presentation, often offering multi-course meals on long-haul flights. Special meals such as vegetarian, diabetic, or religious meals are also provided upon request. The service includes proper table settings, use of standard recipes, and trained cabin crew ensuring professional delivery. Overall, the aim is to enhance passenger comfort and provide a premium travel experience.

23. Describe the significance of correct storage and handling of inflight food service equipment. Correct storage and handling of inflight food service equipment are essential to maintain hygiene, safety, and efficiency. Equipment such as meal carts, trays, and utensils must be stored in clean, dry, and designated areas to prevent contamination. Proper handling ensures that the equipment remains in good condition, reducing the risk of damage or malfunction during service. It also helps in maintaining food quality by preventing cross-contamination. Following standard procedures for cleaning and storage enhances operational efficiency and ensures compliance with safety regulations.

24. Describe the importance of regular maintenance of inflight food service equipment.
Regular maintenance of inflight food service equipment is vital to ensure smooth and safe operations during flights. Equipment like ovens, refrigerators, and meal carts must function properly to maintain food quality and service efficiency. Routine checks help identify faults early, preventing unexpected breakdowns that could disrupt service. Maintenance also ensures compliance with safety and hygiene standards, reducing the risk of contamination or accidents. Well-maintained equipment improves reliability, extends lifespan, and supports consistent service delivery.

25. Classify the different types of special meals planned for diverse passenger needs in inflight service.
Special meals in inflight service are classified based on medical, religious, and lifestyle requirements. Medical meals include diabetic, low-sodium, gluten-free, and low-fat meals designed to meet health needs. Religious meals include halal, kosher, and Hindu meals, prepared according to specific cultural practices. Lifestyle meals include vegetarian, vegan, and child meals, catering to personal preferences. There are also infant meals and meals for passengers with allergies. Proper classification helps airlines meet diverse passenger expectations and ensures comfort and satisfaction during travel.

26. Describe the responsibilities of cabin crew during food-related emergencies.
During food-related emergencies, cabin crew have the responsibility to respond quickly and effectively to ensure passenger safety. They must identify symptoms such as allergic reactions, choking, or food poisoning and provide immediate assistance. Crew members are trained in first aid and may use onboard medical kits or seek help from medical professionals among passengers. They must communicate clearly with the cockpit crew and follow emergency protocols. Proper documentation and reporting of the incident are also essential. Their prompt action can prevent serious health complications.

27. Summarize the role of temperature control in ensuring inflight food quality.
Temperature control is a critical factor in maintaining inflight food quality and safety. Food must be stored, transported, and reheated at appropriate temperatures to prevent microbial growth and spoilage. Cold foods should be kept chilled, while hot foods must be reheated to safe serving temperatures. Maintaining the correct temperature preserves taste, texture, and nutritional value. It also ensures compliance with food safety standards and reduces the risk of foodborne illnesses. Effective temperature control systems are essential for delivering safe and high-quality meals to passengers.

28. Interpret the importance of standard recipes in menu cost control.
Standard recipes play a key role in controlling menu costs in airline catering. They ensure consistency in ingredient quantities, portion sizes, and preparation methods, which helps in accurate cost estimation. By minimizing wastage and avoiding overuse of ingredients, standard recipes contribute to efficient resource utilization. They also support inventory management and budgeting by providing clear guidelines for procurement. Consistency in recipes ensures uniform quality across flights, enhancing passenger satisfaction while maintaining cost efficiency.

Part C

Essays

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

29. Examine common equipment malfunctions affecting inflight food service and discuss preventive measures.

Inflight food service depends heavily on the proper functioning of various equipment such as ovens, refrigerators, beverage makers, and meal carts. Common malfunctions include oven heating failures, refrigeration breakdowns, electrical faults, and mechanical issues in meal carts. These problems can lead to improper heating or storage of food, affecting both food safety and service efficiency. For example, a faulty refrigerator may cause food spoilage, while a malfunctioning oven may prevent proper reheating of meals. Preventive measures include regular inspection, scheduled maintenance, and proper handling of equipment. Cabin crew should be trained to identify early signs of malfunction and report them immediately. Pre-flight checks, adherence to maintenance schedules, and proper cleaning practices also help reduce equipment failures. Ensuring backup systems and contingency planning further supports uninterrupted service.

30. Explain the concept of special meals in inflight food service and discuss their significance for passenger safety and satisfaction.

Special meals in inflight food service are customized meals prepared to meet the specific dietary, medical, religious, or lifestyle requirements of passengers. These include diabetic meals, low-sodium meals, gluten-free meals, halal, kosher, vegetarian, vegan, and infant meals. The concept is based on providing inclusive service that accommodates diverse passenger needs. The significance of special meals lies in ensuring passenger safety, particularly for those with allergies or medical conditions, as inappropriate food can lead to serious health issues. Additionally, offering culturally and religiously appropriate meals enhances passenger comfort and satisfaction. It reflects the airline's commitment to quality service and customer care. Proper labeling, handling, and timely delivery of special meals are essential to maintain trust and prevent errors. Overall, special meals contribute to a positive travel experience and customer loyalty.

31. Describe the role of cabin crew in maintaining service quality, safety, and passenger satisfaction during inflight meal service.

Cabin crew play a vital role in ensuring high standards of service quality, safety, and passenger satisfaction during inflight meal service. They are responsible for the proper handling, reheating, and distribution of meals according to established procedures. Maintaining hygiene and food safety is a key duty, including the use of protective clothing and adherence to sanitation standards. Cabin crew also ensure that passengers receive the correct meals, especially in the case of special dietary requirements. Effective communication, courteous behavior, and prompt service enhance the overall passenger experience. In addition, crew members must monitor passengers for any food-related issues such as allergies or discomfort and respond appropriately. Their professionalism, efficiency, and attention to detail significantly influence passenger satisfaction and the airline's reputation.

32. Discuss the planning and preparation of inflight menus with reference to passenger needs and flight duration.

Planning and preparation of inflight menus is a complex process that considers passenger needs, flight duration, route, and operational constraints. For short-haul flights, menus are usually simple, including light snacks and beverages, while long-haul flights require more elaborate multi-course meals. Passenger needs such as cultural preferences, dietary restrictions, age groups, and health conditions must be taken into account. Menu planning also involves balancing nutrition, taste, and presentation while ensuring food safety and quality. Factors such as limited storage space, reheating facilities, and changes in taste perception at high altitude must be considered. Standard recipes and portion control are used to maintain consistency and cost efficiency. Coordination with ground catering services is essential for timely preparation and delivery of meals. Proper packaging, labeling, and temperature control are crucial to preserve food quality. Overall, effective menu planning enhances passenger satisfaction and ensures a smooth inflight service experience.